THE MARATHAS, SHIVAJI & AURANGZEB'S DECCAN; JAGIRDARI CRISIS

WESTERN DECCAN: TERRAIN BECOMES → CHRONOLOGY FROM THE 1640S → PURANDAR, AGRA AND RECOVERY → CORONATION AND THE LANGUAGE → ASHTAPRADHAN: EIGHT OFFICES, NOT → CHAUTH AND SARDESHMUKHI ARE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◉ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

WESTERN DECCAN: TERRAIN BECOMES A FORT NETWORK

WESTERN DECCAN · TERRAIN BECOMES A FORT NETWORK · SAHYADRI PASSES + MAVAL INFANTRY + KONKAN CREEKS + · AHMADNAGAR/BIJAPUR/MUGHAL COMPETITION OPENS POLITICAL SPACE · MOBILE SERVICE AND POONA BASE; NOT A CONTINUOUS NATIONAL · FORT SYSTEM · STORE + REFUGE + PASS + GARRISON + TREASURY · REVENUE + WATER + REPAIR + INTELLIGENCE + LOCAL

INPUT → Sahyadri passes + Maval infantry + Konkan creeks + agrarian bases

SERVICE → Ahmadnagar/Bijapur/Mughal competition opens political space → SHAHUI → mobile service and Poona base; not a continuous national programme → FORT SYSTEM → store + refuge + pass + garrison + treasury + bargaining

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- INPUT → Sahyadri passes + Maval infantry + Konkan creeks + agrarian bases
- SERVICE → Ahmadnagar/Bijapur/Mughal competition opens political space
- SHAHUI → mobile service and Poona base; not a continuous national programme

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- FORT SYSTEM → store + refuge + pass + garrison + treasury + bargaining
- REQUIRE → revenue + water + repair + intelligence + local cooperation
- VERDICT → organisation converts terrain into power; geography alone cannot.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- MUST REMEMBER: Shivaji's coronation (1674), fort network, revenue claims and military mobility formed a negotiated regional polity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → organisation converts terrain into power; geography alone cannot.

01

STAGE 01

CHRONOLOGY FROM THE 1640S TO 1707

CHRONOLOGY FROM THE 1640S TO 1707 · 1640S FORTS · 1656 JAVLI · 1659 AFZAL KHAN · 1663 SHAISTA KHAN · 1664 SURAT · 1665 PURANDAR · 1666 AGRA

1640s forts → 1656 Javli → 1659 Afzal Khan → 1663 Shaista Khan → 1664 Surat → 1665 Purandar → 1666 Agra → 1670 recovery → 1674 coronation → 1676-79 Karnataka/revenue → 1680 death → 1681 Aurangzeb south → 1686 Bijapur → 1687 Golconda → 1689 Sambhaji → Rajaram/Gingee → 1700 Tarabai

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- 1640s forts → 1656 Javli → 1659 Afzal Khan → 1663 Shaista Khan
- 1664 Surat → 1665 Purandar → 1666 Agra → 1670 recovery

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- 1674 coronation → 1676-79 Karnataka/revenue → 1680 death
- 1681 Aurangzeb south → 1686 Bijapur → 1687 Golconda

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 1689 Sambhaji → Rajaram/Gingee → 1700 Tarabai
- 1700-05 siege cycle → 1707 unresolved imperial exit.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1700-05 siege cycle → 1707 unresolved imperial exit.

02

STAGE 02

PURANDAR, AGRA AND RECOVERY

PURANDAR, AGRA AND RECOVERY · JAI SINGH · SIEGE + DIPLOMACY + PROPOSED MUGHAL-SHIVAJI DECCAN PARTNERSHIP · 23 FORTS SURRENDERED · 12 RETAINED · SAMBHAJI MANSAB 5000 · SUBORDINATE ALLIANCE, NOT ERASED SOVEREIGNTY OR FINAL PEACE · 1666 AGRA

JAI SINGH → siege + diplomacy + proposed Mughal-Shivaji Deccan partnership → 1665 → 23 forts surrendered → 12 retained → Sambhaji mansab 5000 → FORM → subordinate alliance, not erased sovereignty or final peace

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- JAI SINGH → siege + diplomacy + proposed Mughal-Shivaji Deccan partnership
- 1665 → 23 forts surrendered
- 12 retained

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Sambhaji mansab 5000
- FORM → subordinate alliance, not erased sovereignty or final peace
- 1666 AGRA → rank/placement/detention produce honour and trust rupture

DEBATE / LEGACY

- ESCAPE → conflict resumes
- 1670 → forts and Surat recovered/raided
- MISSED SETTLEMENT → possible political choice, never guaranteed outcome.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MISSED SETTLEMENT → possible political choice, never guaranteed outcome.

03

STAGE 03

CORONATION AND THE LANGUAGE OF SOVEREIGNTY

CORONATION AND THE LANGUAGE OF SOVEREIGNTY · 1674 RAIGAD · INDEPENDENT ROYAL RITE AND PUBLIC STATUS · GAGA BHATTA · KSHATRIYA VALIDATION AMID CONTESTED SOCIAL RANK · RISE ABOVE MARATHA CHIEFS + TREATY EQUALITY + DYNASTIC · SANSKRITIC/HINDU KINGSHIP AND REGIONAL POLITICAL IDENTITY · DECCANI-PERSIANATE INSTITUTIONS AND MIXED SERVICE CONTINUE

1674 RAIGAD → independent royal rite and public status

GAGA BHATTA → Kshatriya validation amid contested social rank → PURPOSE → rise above Maratha chiefs + treaty equality + dynastic legitimacy → IDIOM → Sanskritic/Hindu kingship and regional political identity

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 1674 RAIGAD → independent royal rite and public status
- GAGA BHATTA → Kshatriya validation amid contested social rank

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- PURPOSE → rise above Maratha chiefs + treaty equality + dynastic legitimacy
- IDIOM → Sanskritic/Hindu kingship and regional political identity

DEBATE / LEGACY

- BORROWING → Deccani-Persianate institutions and mixed service continue
- TRAP → sovereignty claim is not modern communal nationalism.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → sovereignty claim is not modern communal nationalism.

04

STAGE 04

ASHTAPRADHAN: EIGHT OFFICES, NOT A CABINET

EIGHT OFFICES, NOT A CABINET · ADMINISTRATION, ACCOUNTS, RECORDS, INTELLIGENCE · DIPLOMACY, ARMY, JUSTICE, GRANTS · EACH RESPONSIBLE TO SHIVAJI; NO COLLECTIVE CABINET SOVEREIGNTY · PATIL/DESHMUKH/MIRASDAR/VILLAGE STRUCTURES REMAIN NEGOTIATED · CURB ILLEGAL EXACTION AND OVER-MIGHTY CHIEFS, NOT ABOLISH ALL · SOURCE LIMIT · FORMAL OFFICE LIST DOES NOT PROVE UNIFORM DAILY FUNCTIONING.

PESHWA/AMATYA/SACHIV/MANTRI → administration, accounts, records, intelligence

SUMANT/SENAPATI/NYAYADHISH/PANDITRAO → diplomacy, army, justice, grants → RELATION → each responsible to Shivaji; no collective cabinet sovereignty → LOCAL → patil/deshmukh/mirasdar/village structures remain negotiated

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PESHWA/AMATYA/SACHIV/MANTRI → administration, accounts, records, intelligence
- SUMANT/SENAPATI/NYAYADHISH/PANDITRAO → diplomacy, army, justice, grants

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- RELATION → each responsible to Shivaji; no collective cabinet sovereignty
- LOCAL → patil/deshmukh/mirasdar/village structures remain negotiated

DEBATE / LEGACY

- REFORM → curb illegal exaction and over-mighty chiefs, not abolish all rights
- SOURCE LIMIT → formal office list does not prove uniform daily functioning.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOURCE LIMIT → formal office list does not prove uniform daily functioning.

05

STAGE 05

CHAUTH AND SARDESHMUKHI ARE DISTINCT CLAIMS

CHAUTH AND SARDESHMUKHI ARE DISTINCT CLAIMS · MEASUREMENT/CLASSIFICATION + VILLAGE OFFICERS + ANNAJI 1679 · ABOUT TWO-FIFTHS PLUS CESSES IS DEBATED; DO NOT UNIVERSALISE · ONE-FOURTH PROTECTION/NON-RAIDING AND LATER POLITICAL CLAIM · SEPARATE ADDITIONAL 10% SUPERIOR-DESHMUKH CLAIM · LATE WAR · KAMAISHDARS TURN CHAUTH INTO PARALLEL DISTRICT COLLECTION · FISCAL CLAIM DOES NOT AUTOMATICALLY EQUAL TERRITORIAL SOVEREIGNTY.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
ASSESSMENT → measurement/classification + village officers + Annaji 1679	CHAUTH → one-fourth protection/non-raiding and later political claim	LATE WAR → kamaishdars turn chauth into parallel district collection
INCIDENCE → about two-fifths plus cesses is debated; do not universalise	SARDESHMUKHI → separate additional 10% superior-deshmukh claim	TRAP → fiscal claim does not automatically equal territorial sovereignty.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ASSESSMENT → measurement/classification + village officers + Annaji 1679
- INCIDENCE → about two-fifths plus cesses is debated; do not universalise

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- CHAUTH → one-fourth protection/non-raiding and later political claim
- SARDESHMUKHI → separate additional 10% superior-deshmukh claim

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LATE WAR → kamaishdars turn chauth into parallel district collection
- TRAP → fiscal claim does not automatically equal territorial sovereignty.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → fiscal claim does not automatically equal territorial sovereignty.

06

STAGE 06

CAVALRY AND GANIMI KAVA

CAVALRY AND GANIMI KAVA · MAVALI INFANTRY + LIGHT CAVALRY + FORTS + INTELLIGENCE · SPEED + DISPERSAL + NIGHT ATTACK + SUPPLY DISRUPTION · GANIMI KAVA · ADAPTIVE ENEMY-STYLE IRREGULAR WAR, NOT TIMELESS DOCTRINE · SIEGES, DEFENCE AND SET BATTLES REMAIN PART OF WAR · MUGHAL BURDEN · LONG ROUTES + GARRISONS + SEASONS + ELUSIVE OPPONENTS

FORCE → Mavali infantry + light cavalry + forts + intelligence → METHOD → speed + dispersal + night attack + supply disruption + negotiation → GANIMI KAVA → adaptive enemy-style irregular war, not timeless doctrine → ALSO → sieges, defence and set battles remain part of war → MUGHAL BURDEN → long routes + garrisons + seasons + elusive opponents

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- FORCE → Mavali infantry + light cavalry + forts + intelligence
- METHOD → speed + dispersal + night attack + supply disruption + negotiation

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- GANIMI KAVA → adaptive enemy-style irregular war, not timeless doctrine
- ALSO → sieges, defence and set battles remain part of war

DEBATE / LEGACY

- MUGHAL BURDEN → long routes + garrisons + seasons + elusive opponents
- VERDICT → mobility worked as a system with forts and local revenue.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → mobility worked as a system with forts and local revenue.

07

STAGE 07

COAST AND NAVY: CAPABILITY WITH SCALE LIMITS

COAST AND NAVY · CAPABILITY WITH SCALE LIMITS · KOLI + BHANDARI + MUSLIM + MARATHA SEAFARING PERSONNEL · GRABS/GALLIVATS/GUNBOATS + TRADING AND SUPPLY VESSELS · SINDHUDURG/VIJAYDURG/COASTAL NODES SUPPORT CREEKS AND ROUTES · SIDI CHECK + TRADE/PROTECTION + SUPPLY + INTELLIGENCE · NEGOTIATE/CONTEST PORTUGUESE AND ENGLISH PRESENCE · REGIONAL LITTORAL CAPABILITY, NEVER INDIAN OCEAN BLUE-WATER COMMAND.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PEOPLE → Koli + Bhandari + Muslim + Maratha seafaring personnel
- CRAFT → grabs/gallivats/gunboats + trading and supply vessels

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- FORTS → Sindhudurg/Vijaydurg/coastal nodes support creeks and routes
- AIMS → Sidi check + trade/protection + supply + intelligence

DEBATE / LEGACY

- EUROPEANS → negotiate/contest Portuguese and English presence
- LIMIT → regional littoral capability, never Indian Ocean blue-water command.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → regional littoral capability, never Indian Ocean blue-water command.

08

STAGE 08

RESISTANCE AFTER SHIVAJI

RESISTANCE AFTER SHIVAJI · SAMBHAJI WINS SUCCESSION · PRINCE AKBAR CONNECTION · CAPTURE/EXECUTION REMOVES RECOGNISED HEAD, NOT RESISTANCE · ESCAPES TO GINGEE; DISTANT ROYAL CENTRE + DISPERSED COMMANDERS · GINGEE FALLS AFTER RAJARAM ESCAPES · TARABAI LEADS FOR SHIVAJI II · DECENTRALISATION INCREASES RESILIENCE AND COMMANDER AUTONOMY.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 1680 → Sambhaji wins succession
- 1681 → Prince Akbar connection
- 1689 → capture/execution removes recognised head, not resistance

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- RAJARAM → escapes to Gingee; distant royal centre + dispersed commanders
- 1698 → Gingee falls after Rajaram escapes
- 1700 → Tarabai leads for Shivaji II

DEBATE / LEGACY

- EFFECT → decentralisation increases resilience and commander autonomy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EFFECT → decentralisation increases resilience and commander autonomy.

09

STAGE 09

ANNEXATION REMOVES BUFFERS

ANNEXATION REMOVES BUFFERS · 1686 BIJAPUR + 1687 GOLCONDA · DIRECT MUGHAL ANNEXATION · TERRITORY, FORTS, TREASURY CLAIMS AND FORMAL SOVEREIGNTY · BUFFERS, NEGOTIABLE COURTS AND LOCAL RESPONSIBILITY · DECCANI NOBLES/SOLDIERS + GARRISONS + LONG ROUTES + ADMINISTRATION · LOOP 1700-05 · CAPTURE FORT

1686 BIJAPUR + 1687 GOLCONDA → direct Mughal annexation → GAIN → territory, forts, treasury claims and formal sovereignty → LOSS → buffers, negotiable courts and local responsibility → ADD → Deccani nobles/soldiers + garrisons + long routes + administration → LOOP 1700-05 → capture fort → garrison → move → Maratha return

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 1686 BIJAPUR + 1687 GOLCONDA → direct Mughal annexation
- GAIN → territory, forts, treasury claims and formal sovereignty
- LOSS → buffers, negotiable courts and local responsibility

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- ADD → Deccani nobles/soldiers + garrisons + long routes + administration
- LOOP 1700-05 → capture fort → garrison → move → Maratha return
- VERDICT → conquest expands commitments faster than durable pacification.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Ashtapradhan was not a modern cabinet; chauth and sardeshmukhi varied by claim, agreement, collection and territory.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → conquest expands commitments faster than durable pacification.

10

STAGE 10

JAGIRDARI TERMS AND THE FEEDBACK LOOP

JAGIRDARI TERMS AND THE FEEDBACK LOOP · DELAY/SHORTAGE OF PRODUCTIVE ASSIGNMENT · UNSETTLED POOL · PAPER CLAIM EXCEEDS COLLECTION IN WAR-TORN DISTRICTS · PARALLEL MARATHA CLAIM · PRIVATE PACT · JAGIRDAR PROTECTS COLLECTION · EXPANDED ELITE

BE-JAGIRI → delay/shortage of productive assignment

PAIBAQI → unsettled pool → JAMA/HASIL → paper claim exceeds collection in war-torn districts → CHAUTH → parallel Maratha claim

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- BE-JAGIRI → delay/shortage of productive assignment
- PAIBAQI → unsettled pool
- JAMA/HASIL → paper claim exceeds collection in war-torn districts

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- CHAUTH → parallel Maratha claim
- PRIVATE PACT → jagirdar protects collection
- EXPANDED ELITE → Mughal + Deccani + Maratha claimants

DEBATE / LEGACY

- FEEDBACK → bad jagir → weak troops/harsh collection → resistance → lower hasil
- DEBATE → fiscal + administrative + military + social crisis, not one variable.
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Deccan war and jagirdari crisis interacted with succession, ecology and regional resistance but do not alone explain decline.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Deccan war and jagirdari crisis interacted with succession, ecology and regional resistance but do not alone explain decline.

11

STAGE 11

TOPIC 23 FINAL ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 23 FINAL ANSWER SPINE · ECOLOGY AND SHAHUI SERVICE WORLD; NO GEOGRAPHY/NATIONALIST DETERMINISM · REVENUE + CHAUTH/SARDESHMUKHI + ARMY + LITTORAL NAVY · 1686/87 ANNEXATION · LOGISTICS LOOP · JAGIR FEEDBACK · ZERO DIRECT TOPIC-23 ROUTES, 2018-2026; MAINS HAS NO KEY · TOPIC 22 RELIGION/RAJPUTS

START → ecology and Shahji service world; no geography/nationalist determinism → TRACE → forts/Javli → Purandar/Agra → coronation → institutions → EXPLAIN → revenue + chauth/sardeshmukhi + army + littoral navy → SUCCESSORS → Sambhaji → Rajaram/Gingee → Tarabai → IMPERIAL → 1686/87 annexation → logistics loop → jagir feedback

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- START → ecology and Shahji service world; no geography/nationalist determinism
- TRACE → forts/Javli → Purandar/Agra → coronation → institutions
- EXPLAIN → revenue + chauth/sardeshmukhi + army + littoral navy

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- SUCCESSORS → Sambhaji → Rajaram/Gingee → Tarabai
- IMPERIAL → 1686/87 annexation → logistics loop → jagir feedback
- PYQ → zero direct Topic-23 routes, 2018-2026; Mains has no key

DEBATE / LEGACY

- BOUND → Topic 22 religion/Rajputs
- Topic 25 full decline
- VERDICT → regional state resilience exposed Mughal overextension.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → regional state resilience exposed Mughal overextension.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ADVANCED EVIDENCE NOTEBOOK · TWENTY-EIGHT SOURCE-TO-ARGUMENT LABS · EVIDENCE AND ANSWER-WRITING DRILLS · THE MARATHAS, SHIVAJI & AURANGZEB'S DECCAN; JAGIRDARI CRISIS — · 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA · 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION · 3. STUDY LINKS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Advanced evidence notebook: twenty-eight source-to-argument labs
- Evidence and answer-writing drills
- The Marathas, Shivaji & Aurangzeb's Deccan; Jagirdari Crisis — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles
- + Concept — Jagirdari crisis in one line

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels